TinkerWithMe

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AI Movie Studio · Full Curriculum

Full-day camp (5 hrs) · 10–14 yrs · Beginner → Intermediate

Full facilitator curriculum PREMIUM

Overview

Produce a short film powered entirely by AI, then premiere it for parents.

DETAIL	
Track	AI Skills for Kids
Format	Full-day camp (5 hrs)
Ages	10–14 yrs
Level	Beginner → Intermediate
Price	from KES 7,000
Standalone	Yes
Prerequisites	None — standalone

Course Overview

AI Movie Studio is a one-day, five-hour intensive in which teams of two to three students write, illustrate, score, and edit a complete 60–120 second short film using AI tools at every stage of production — then premiere it for parents at pickup, just like a real studio wrap party. Students never touch a camera; instead they direct AI the way a real producer directs a crew, learning to write clear creative briefs (prompts) and to curate, combine, and refine AI output into a finished, watchable story.

The day is built as a real production pipeline: Session 1 (Script) locks the story and dialogue using ChatGPT as a brainstorming and drafting partner; Session 2 (Visuals) turns that script into a consistent set of AI-generated storyboard images and backgrounds; Session 3 (Audio) layers in AI-generated music, sound effects, and optional narration to build mood; Session 4 (Edit & Premiere) brings everything together in CapCut and ends with a live screening for parents. Each session's output becomes the raw material for the next, so nothing is wasted and every team leaves with a genuinely finished product, not a demo.

The take-home is the finished short film itself, exported as an MP4 and shared via a link (Google Drive, WeTransfer, or similar), plus the full asset folder (script, images, audio) so families can see the whole creative process behind the final cut.

Learning Outcomes

- Write an effective, specific prompt for a text-based AI (role, audience, constraints) and iterate on AI output rather than accepting the first draft
- Apply basic three-act story structure (setup, conflict, resolution) to build an original short story with a clear beginning, middle, and end
- Craft image-generation prompts using the subject–action–setting–style–mood formula, and maintain visual character consistency across multiple AI-generated images
- Use AI music and sound-effect generation to match audio mood to on-screen story beats
- Assemble images, audio, and text into a sequenced timeline in a video editor, applying trimming, transitions, and captions
- Export a finished video file at the correct resolution and troubleshoot common technical issues (audio balance, timing, aspect ratio)
- Present and explain creative choices to a real audience during a public screening

Materials Master List

ITEM	SPEC	QTY PER STUDENT/ GROUP	NOTES
Laptop or Chromebook	Min 4GB RAM, Chrome browser installed, webcam not required, CapCut desktop app pre-installed where possible	1 per pair (2–3 students)	Facilitator should charge and test all devices the evening before; keep 2 spare devices for the venue
Wi-Fi router / mobile hotspot	4G hotspot (Safaricom/Airtel) with min 10 Mbps, or venue Wi-Fi		

		1 primary + 1 backup per venue	Critical dependency — test bandwidth with 8+ devices connected before camp day
4-way extension power strips	Standard Kenyan 3-pin, surge-protected	4–6 per venue	Position near seating clusters, tape cables down
Wired headphones with mic	3.5mm jack, adjustable headband	1 per student	Needed for audio session listening and any live voice recording
Printed storyboard template (A4, 6-panel grid with caption lines)	A4, single-sided, black & white	3 sheets per student	Facilitator prints in advance; used in Sessions 1–2
Character & scene planning worksheet	A4, sections for character name/look, setting, mood	1 per student	Used to draft prompt details before typing into AI tools
Pencils, erasers, fine-liner pens	HB pencil, fine-tip black pen	1 set per student	For storyboard sketching and note-taking
Sticky notes (assorted colours, 3x3in)	Standard pad	1 pad per team	Scene brainstorming and voting on story ideas
Index cards	Plain, unruled	20 per team	One scene per card for physical script sequencing
USB flash drives	16GB minimum	1 per team	Backup export/transfer of images, audio, final film
Whiteboard/flipchart + markers	Standard classroom set	1 per venue	Facilitator demos and story-structure diagrams
Projector + screen or large TV with HDMI	1080p capable	1 per venue	Used for demos throughout and the final parent premiere
External speaker (Bluetooth or wired)	Min 10W, clear audio	1 per venue	Essential for premiere screening audio quality
Shared "studio" login accounts	Pre-created facilitator-owned accounts: ChatGPT, Microsoft account (Bing Image Creator/Designer), Suno, ElevenLabs, CapCut	1 login per team, printed on a card	Facilitator sets these up 13+ compliant in advance; students never create personal accounts
Backup royalty-free music/SFX folder	10 pre-downloaded mood-labelled tracks + 15 common SFX clips	1 copy on facilitator laptop + USB	Offline fallback if internet drops during Session 3
Name tags / team cards	Card stock, marker for names	1 per student	Also used to label team folders/USBs

Visible countdown timer	Large digital or phone timer projected	1 per venue	Keeps all sessions on pace
Parent consent/ release forms	Covers AI-tool use, image generation, screening/sharing of final film	1 per student, signed prior to camp	Must be collected before Session 1 begins
Printed premiere programme	A5, lists team names and film titles	1 per parent attending	Prepared during Session 4 once titles are finalised

Session Plans

Session 1 — Script: ChatGPT-Assisted Story Writing and Dialogue

Objectives

- Apply a simple three-act story structure to an original idea
- Use ChatGPT to brainstorm, draft, and revise a short story and its dialogue through iterative prompting
- Produce a finished 5-scene shot list with dialogue, ready to hand to the Visuals session

Timing (60 minutes)

- 0–10 min: Welcome, team formation (pairs/trios), show a 90-second example AI-made short film, introduce the day's pipeline
- 10–20 min: Mini-lesson on 3-act story structure and the "one-sentence pitch" formula
- 20–25 min: Paper brainstorm — genre, main character, goal, obstacle
- 25–45 min: ChatGPT session — generate ideas, pick one, develop outline and dialogue
- 45–55 min: Convert outline into the shot-list template (scene, setting, characters, action, dialogue, camera note)
- 55–60 min: Quick share-out — each team reads their one-line logline aloud

Step-by-step teaching instructions

1. Open with the example short film on the projector. Ask: "What made this story easy to follow in under two minutes?" Draw out answers: clear character, clear problem, clear ending.

2. On the whiteboard, draw a simple three-box diagram: Setup → Problem → Solution. Explain that every scene in their film should serve one of these three boxes.
3. Teach the pitch formula: "[Character] wants [goal], but [obstacle] gets in the way, until [resolution]." Give a live example: "A shy boy wants to win the school talent show, but he loses his voice the morning of, until his friends help him perform with sign language and music instead."
4. Hand out sticky notes. Each team writes 3 possible one-sentence pitches using the formula, then circles their favourite.
5. Assign each team their shared ChatGPT login card. Walk them through logging in as a group.
6. Demonstrate the first prompt live on the projector before releasing teams to work independently.
7. Circulate for the next 20 minutes, prompting teams to push past ChatGPT's first draft with a follow-up refinement request.
8. At the 45-minute mark, hand out the printed shot-list template and show how to transfer the ChatGPT outline into the scene-by-scene table.
9. Close with loglines shared aloud — this builds excitement and gives the facilitator a quick check that every team has a workable story.

Build detail

Tool: ChatGPT (chat.openai.com), logged in on the shared "studio" account provided on each team's card. Free tier (GPT-3.5/GPT-4o-mini) is sufficient.

Workflow and exact prompts to use, in order:

1. "You are a creative writing partner for a group of Kenyan kids aged 10 to 14 making a 2-minute short film. Help me brainstorm 3 fun movie ideas about [insert team's chosen topic/genre]. For each idea give: a 1-sentence logline, main character, setting, problem, and how it's solved. Keep it simple, positive, and appropriate for a family audience."
2. Team picks their favourite idea, then types: "Great, let's develop idea 2. Write a simple 5-scene story outline: Scene 1 (Opening), Scene 2 (Problem appears), Scene 3 (Character tries and fails), Scene 4 (Character finds a solution), Scene 5 (Happy ending). One sentence per scene."

3. "Now write short dialogue, 2 to 3 lines per character, for Scene 3. The characters are [Name1] and [Name2]. Keep every line under 15 words and make it sound like real kids talking, not too formal."
4. "Turn this whole story into a table with these columns: Scene #, Setting description, Characters in scene, Action, Dialogue, Camera note (wide shot / close-up / etc)."

What a good result looks like: a clean 5-row table with one clear conflict, dialogue lines short enough to read aloud in 3–4 seconds each, and camera notes that a 10-year-old can visualise (e.g. "wide shot of the market," "close-up on her worried face").

Testing/iteration: have teams read the dialogue aloud. If a line takes longer than about 4 seconds to say, tell them to prompt: "Make the dialogue in Scene 3 shorter and funnier for a 10-year-old audience." Regenerate and compare.

Checks for understanding

- What are the three parts of story structure, and can you point to them in your own outline?
- Why did we tell ChatGPT the audience is "kids aged 10 to 14" in our very first prompt?
- What would you type next if the dialogue ChatGPT gave you felt too long or too grown-up?

Common mistakes & fixes

MISTAKE	FIX
Story idea has multiple subplots or too many characters	Restrict to one clear conflict and max 5 scenes; ask ChatGPT to "simplify to one problem"
Team copies ChatGPT's first draft without changes	Require at least one revision prompt before moving to the shot-list table
Dialogue lines are too long to read on screen	Prompt: "shorten every line to under 10 words"
Team members disagree on which idea to use	Vote by sticky-note dots, or ask ChatGPT to "combine idea 1 and idea 3 into one story"

Session 2 — Visuals: AI Image Generation for Storyboards and Backgrounds

Objectives

- Understand the anatomy of a strong text-to-image prompt
- Generate a visually consistent set of images for every scene in the shot list
- Organise and export images in correct sequence for editing

Timing (75 minutes)

- 0–10 min: Recap script, show example generated storyboard set
- 10–20 min: Mini-lesson — anatomy of an image prompt (subject + action + setting + style + mood + camera angle)
- 20–25 min: Live demo — generate one scene image, iterate based on class suggestions
- 25–60 min: Teams generate images for each of their 5 scenes, keeping character description consistent
- 60–70 min: Teams select best image per scene, download and rename files in order
- 70–75 min: Quick gallery walk — teams view each other's storyboards for inspiration

Step-by-step teaching instructions

1. Project the example storyboard set from Session 1's demo film. Point out how the same character looks identical across every image.
2. On the whiteboard, write the prompt formula: *Subject + Action + Setting + Art Style + Mood/Lighting + Camera Angle*. Build one prompt live, piece by piece, asking students to suggest each ingredient.
3. Generate that live prompt on the projector, show 2–3 results, and pick the best one together — narrate your reasoning out loud.
4. Hand out team logins for the image tool. Show students exactly where to paste the character-description sentence so it stays identical every time.
5. Release teams to generate images scene by scene, using their shot-list table from Session 1 as their prompt source.
6. Circulate, checking that character descriptions are copy-pasted verbatim across scenes, not retyped from memory.

7. At 60 minutes, show how to download and rename files as 01_scene1.png, 02_scene2.png, etc., into their team folder.
8. Run a 5-minute gallery walk: teams leave their laptop open to their best image and rotate to view others.

Build detail

Tool: Bing Image Creator via Microsoft Designer (free with the shared Microsoft studio account), with Canva Magic Media as a backup if Bing is slow or blocked at the venue.

Workflow:

1. Log in to the shared studio Microsoft account. Go to Microsoft Designer / Bing Image Creator.
2. For each scene in the shot list, build a prompt using the formula. Keep the character description block identical, word-for-word, in every single prompt.
3. Example Scene 1 prompt: "A brave 12-year-old Kenyan girl with braided hair, wearing a red hoodie and blue sneakers, standing confidently in a colourful outdoor market in Nairobi, Pixar-style 3D cartoon, bright sunny mood, wide shot."
4. Example Scene 3 prompt (same character block reused): "A brave 12-year-old Kenyan girl with braided hair, wearing a red hoodie and blue sneakers, looking worried and searching through market stalls, Pixar-style 3D cartoon, tense late-afternoon mood, medium shot."
5. Generate 4 options per prompt, choose the closest match to the story and to the previously chosen art style.
6. Download the chosen image and save it into the team's labelled folder with a sequential filename (01_, 02_, 03_...).
7. Repeat for all 5 scenes plus one optional title-card image (character name/story title over a background).

What a good result looks like: 5–6 images, same art style throughout (e.g. all Pixar-style 3D, not mixing cartoon and photo-real), the main character visually recognisable scene to scene, and each image clearly matching its scene's action from the shot list.

Testing/iteration: lay all images side by side (open a shared team folder in gallery view). If the character's hair, outfit, or age looks different between scenes, tell students to check they used the exact same description text — reissue the prompt with the corrected description. If an image is odd, blank, or inappropriate, generate again rather than downloading it.

Checks for understanding

- What are the four to six ingredients of a strong image prompt?
- How do we keep our main character looking the same in every scene?
- What should you do if the AI gives you an image that doesn't match your story at all?

Common mistakes & fixes

MISTAKE	FIX
Vague prompts like "a girl in a market"	Add style, mood, action, and camera details every time
Character's look changes between scenes	Reuse the exact same description sentence in every prompt, copy-pasted not retyped
Team downloads an odd or off-topic image just to save time	Facilitator reviews before download; regenerate until it matches the shot list
Images saved with random names, out of order	Rename immediately after each download using the 01_, 02_, 03_ numbering system

Session 3 — Audio: AI-Generated Music, Sound Effects, and Optional Narration

Objectives

- Generate a mood-matched background music track using an AI music tool
- Select or generate sound effects that reinforce key story beats
- Optionally produce AI narration or record student narration for storytelling clarity

Timing (60 minutes)

- 0–5 min: Recap, explain why audio matters (mood, pacing, immersion)
- 5–15 min: Mini-lesson — play the same clip with and without music/SFX, discuss the difference

- 15–35 min: Teams generate a theme track matching their story's mood using the shared music tool
- 35–45 min: Teams find/download 2–4 sound effects matching key actions in their shot list
- 45–55 min: Optional narration — generate via AI voice tool or record a team member reading narrator lines
- 55–60 min: Export and label all audio files into the team folder by scene number

Step-by-step teaching instructions

1. Play a 15-second clip from the demo film twice: once muted, once with full music and sound effects. Ask: "Which one made you feel something? Why?"
2. Explain that music sets overall mood (adventurous, funny, sad) while sound effects punctuate specific moments (a door creak, footsteps, applause).
3. Demo generating one music track live on the projector using the exact prompt structure below, and play both options generated before choosing one.
4. Release teams to their shared music tool login to generate their own track based on their story's mood.
5. After 20 minutes, move teams to sound effect sourcing — demonstrate searching a free sound library.
6. Offer the optional narration step only to teams that finish early or whose story needs a narrator to explain the plot; others can rely on captions in Session 4 instead.
7. In the final 5 minutes, check every team has a music file and at least 2 sound effect files saved and correctly labelled.

Build detail

Music tool: Suno (suno.com), shared studio account. Log in, click "Create," enter a mood/style prompt.

Example prompt: "Instrumental, upbeat marimba and drums, adventurous African-inspired background music, 30 seconds, no vocals." Another mood option: "Instrumental, gentle piano and soft strings, calm and hopeful, 25 seconds, no vocals."

Generate 2 versions, play both against the storyboard images already open on screen, pick the one that best matches the mood, and download as an mp3 into the team folder.

Backup if internet is slow: facilitator's pre-downloaded royalty-free track folder (on USB), labelled by mood (Adventure, Funny, Calm, Suspense, Happy Ending) — teams pick the closest match instead.

Sound effects: Pixabay Sound Effects or Freesound.org (no login required), search specific keywords matching shot-list actions, e.g. "footsteps on gravel," "market crowd chatter," "cheerful applause," "door creak." Preview before downloading, save as mp3/wav into the team folder labelled by scene (e.g. sfx_scene2_footsteps.mp3).

Optional narration: ElevenLabs (elevenlabs.io), shared studio account. Paste the narrator's lines from the script into the text box, choose a friendly preset voice, click Generate, download the mp3. Alternative: one team member reads the narration aloud, recorded on a phone or laptop mic, to be added directly in CapCut during Session 4.

What a good result looks like: one 20–40 second instrumental track that matches the story's overall mood, 2–4 short sound effect clips clearly tied to specific actions, and (if used) a narration clip that is clear and correctly paced.

Testing/iteration: play the music against the storyboard slideshow — does the mood match the images? If it feels wrong (too slow for an adventure, too intense for a comedy), regenerate with adjusted mood words rather than settling for the first result.

Checks for understanding

- How does music change the way an audience feels about a scene, even without dialogue?
- Why do we want a short 20–30 second music track rather than a full 3-minute song?
- What's our backup plan if the internet is too slow to generate music?

Common mistakes & fixes

MISTAKE	FIX
Music track is too long or has vocals that clash with dialogue	Select "instrumental" / "no vocals" explicitly in the prompt
Sound effect doesn't match the action it's meant to support	Search more specific keywords and preview before downloading
Team forgets to save/download the generated audio file	Use a checklist: confirm the file appears in the team folder before moving on
Team wants to use a copyrighted song from YouTube	Explain premiere rules clearly — only AI-generated or royalty-free audio may be used

Session 4 — Edit & Premiere: Assemble in CapCut, Screen for Parents

Objectives

- Import and sequence images, music, sound effects, and captions on a CapCut timeline
- Apply basic edits (trimming, transitions, text timing, volume balancing) to produce a cohesive short film
- Export the final film correctly and deliver it in a live premiere screening for parents

Timing (90 minutes)

- 0–10 min: Recap all assets ready (checklist), introduce CapCut interface live on the projector
- 10–20 min: Demo — import images, arrange on timeline, add music, trim to match total length
- 20–25 min: Demo — add text captions and simple transitions
- 25–65 min: Teams build their films independently; facilitator circulates for 1:1 troubleshooting
- 65–75 min: Export films, test-play each on the premiere screen/device to catch technical issues
- 75–80 min: Set up premiere — seating, screening order, title cards
- 80–90 min: Premiere screening for parents — each team introduces their film (30 seconds), film plays, applause, certificates

Step-by-step teaching instructions

1. Confirm every team has their full asset checklist: 5–6 numbered images, 1 music track, 2–4 sound effects, optional narration. No team starts editing until this is confirmed.
2. Open CapCut on the projector. Show: New Project → set aspect ratio (16:9 for a TV/projector premiere, or 9:16 if screening on phones) → Media Bin → import all files.
3. Demo dragging images onto the main timeline in order, then dragging each clip's edge to set duration (roughly 4–6 seconds per image, timed to match how long its dialogue takes to read).
4. Demo adding the music track to a second audio layer, trimming it to match total video length, and lowering its volume to roughly 30–40%.
5. Demo adding one text caption: Text → Add Text → type a dialogue line → position bottom third → set duration to match the scene → choose a bold, readable font.
6. Demo adding one simple transition between two clips (Fade or Slide) — explicitly warn against overusing flashy transitions.
7. Release teams to build independently. Circulate constantly; keep a visible 15-minutes-to-export warning on the timer.
8. At the export stage, demo Export → 1080p → Save, then show how to copy the file onto the team's USB drive labelled TeamName_Film.mp4.
9. Test-play every film once on the premiere screen/speaker system before parents arrive to catch playback issues early.
10. Run the premiere: dim the lights if possible, MC (facilitator or a confident student) introduces each team, plays films back-to-back from one master laptop/folder to avoid switching devices, and closes with certificates and a group photo.

Build detail

Tool: CapCut desktop app (pre-installed on devices ahead of camp) or CapCut Web at capcut.com as a fallback, using the shared studio account.

Exact workflow:

1. Open CapCut → New Project → set resolution/aspect ratio for the intended screening device.

2. Import Media: drag all numbered images and all audio files from the team folder into the Media Bin.
3. Drag images onto the main timeline in scene order (01, 02, 03...); adjust each clip's length by dragging its edge.
4. Drag the music track onto Audio Track 2; trim its start/end to match the total video length; select the clip and lower its volume slider to ~30–40%.
5. Drag each sound effect clip onto Audio Track 3, positioning it directly under the matching image/action moment on the timeline.
6. Add text captions for key dialogue lines via Text → Add Text; set position, font size (large, bold, high-contrast), and duration to match the scene's screen time.
7. Add a Fade or Slide transition between clips by clicking the small transition icon that appears between two adjacent clips on the timeline.
8. Preview the whole film with sound. Watch specifically for: captions disappearing too fast, music overpowering narration, images out of order, or awkward pacing.
9. Export via Export → choose 1080p → Save to device → copy to USB, named TeamName_Film.mp4.

What a good result looks like: a 60–120 second film with images in correct order, background music present and balanced under any dialogue/narration, readable captions, smooth (not overused) transitions, and a successful export that plays back cleanly.

Testing/iteration: the full team watches their edit together with sound on before exporting, checking off: images in order? captions readable? music not too loud? total length under 2 minutes? Only export once all four are confirmed; export an early safety draft at the halfway point in case of time pressure.

Checks for understanding

- What is the correct layer order on our timeline — images, music, sound effects, text?
- What do you do if your captions disappear before anyone can finish reading them?
- Why do we lower the music volume under dialogue or narration instead of leaving it at full volume?

Common mistakes & fixes

MISTAKE	FIX
Images stay on screen too briefly, rushing the story	Drag the clip's edge to extend its duration to match the dialogue's reading pace
Music overpowers narration or dialogue captions	Select the music clip and lower its volume slider to roughly 30%
Team runs out of time before exporting	Set a 15-minute export warning alarm; export a safety draft mid-session
Wrong aspect ratio for the premiere screen	Confirm the screening device (TV/projector vs phone) before starting the project, set ratio at project creation

Assessment & Showcase

Assessment across the day is formative and rubric-based rather than test-based — the facilitator observes each team against four simple criteria at the end of each relevant session, scoring each as Emerging, Developing, or Accomplished:

- **Story** (Session 1): Is there a clear character, problem, and resolution? Was dialogue revised at least once based on facilitator or peer feedback?
- **Visuals** (Session 2): Are images consistent in style and character appearance across all scenes? Do images clearly match the shot list actions?
- **Sound** (Session 3): Does the music/SFX mood match the story tone? Are audio files correctly labelled and complete?
- **Craft** (Session 4): Is the film correctly sequenced, exported, and playable start to finish without errors?

"Done" means: a single exported MP4 file, 60–120 seconds long, containing all five-plus scenes in order, background music present and balanced, readable captions or narration, and a successful, error-free playback test completed before parents arrive. Every team member should also be able to explain, in one sentence, one creative choice they made (e.g. "we chose upbeat music because our story is about winning a race").

The premiere itself is the final showcase: set up the room like a real cinema (dim lighting if possible, seating facing the screen, an optional red-carpet entrance strip). Print a one-page programme listing team names and film titles. An MC (facilitator or confident student volunteer) introduces each film by title and team before it plays; all films run back-to-back from one master laptop/folder to avoid device-switching delays. Close with a round of applause, certificate presentation to every student, and a group photo with parents.

Extension & Home Challenges

- **Easy:** Using the same images and audio, re-cut a 15-second "trailer" version of the film in a different scene order, designed as a teaser for social media.
- **Medium:** Replace all on-screen text captions with full AI-generated voice narration (using ElevenLabs), re-timing every scene in CapCut so the visuals match the new spoken pacing.
- **Hard:** Extend the film with a new AI-generated title sequence and end-credits scene (new background image plus a short new AI music variation for the credits), then export two final versions — one 16:9 for screen viewing and one 9:16 optimised for phone/reels sharing.